Menhir–In Breton Language 'Men' means "stone" and 'hir', "long." They are monolithic pillars planted vertically into the ground in memory of the dead.



Menhir at Singaripalayam in Tirupur District and at Vembur in Theni District points to the existence of an ancient settlement along the banks of River Uppar. Menhirs are found at Narasingampatti, Madurai district, Kumarikalpalayam and Kodumanal in Erode district.



Pulimankombai 3rd Century BC (BCE)

Hero Stones – A Hero Stone is a memorial stone raised in remembrance of the honourable death of a hero in a battle or those who lost their lives while defending their village from animals or enemies. Hero stones are found at Maanur village near Palani, Dindigul district, Vellalankottai, Tuticorin district, and Pulimankombai, Dindigul district.

Summary

- The Aryans migrated to India around 1500 BC (BCE). The Vedic texts form an important source of this period.
- Rig Vedic polity was kinship-based.
- When the Aryans moved east ward, the early settlements were replaced by their territorial kingdoms.
- Use of iron plough and axe helped more areas of land under cultivation.
- New crafts and arts developed. It paved the way for urbanisation in the Gangetic plain.
- The later Vedic society in North India and the Iron Age society in South India belong to the same period.

GLOSSARY

Eternal	-	existing for ever (நிலையான)
Kinship	-	blood relationship (இரத்த உறவு)
Patriarchal	-	a system of society controlled by men (தந்தை வழிச் சமூகம்)
Deity	-	a god or goddess (தெய்வம்)
Contemporary	-	living or occurring at the same time (சமகாலத்தில்)
Metallurgy	-	the branch of science and technology concerned with the properties of metals and their production (உலோகவியல்)

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